PROJECT BRIEF: Solara Rewards App Redesign — Phase 1

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1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

Fantasy has been engaged to redesign the Solara Rewards mobile app — a loyalty and hospitality product serving millions of members across 48 Solara Entertainment Group properties. The current app is a decade-old, iframe-heavy product that has outgrown its architecture and no longer reflects the premium brand it represents.

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2. BACKGROUND & CONTEXT

About Solara Entertainment Group

Solara Entertainment Group is one of the largest gaming and hospitality companies in the United States, operating 48 properties across 22 states. While best known for its flagship destination resorts — including several properties on the Las Vegas Strip — the majority of its portfolio is regional casino properties serving local members who visit regularly. Solara's brand positioning is "approachable luxury": premium experiences that feel accessible, not exclusive.

The Solara Rewards loyalty program is the primary vehicle for member retention and visit frequency. Members earn tier credits and reward credits through gaming, hotel stays, dining, and entertainment spend. The program has multiple tiers — Gold, Platinum, Diamond, and Zenith (top tier) — with a new tier in development. Earning has historically been weighted toward gaming; Solara is now expanding recognition to hospitality spend more broadly.

How we got here

The app was originally built by an external studio approximately 10 years ago, under the program's former name. When the program rebranded, the app was reskinned but the codebase was never touched. Daniel Reyes's Digital Commerce team inherited it roughly 2–3 years ago — no design files, no documentation.

The pandemic froze development entirely. Survival mode meant adding iframes wherever native development wasn't possible. The result is what Daniel Reyes calls "a glorified web browser" — booking, offers, dining, and experiences are web views stitched into a native shell, making cross-surface personalization technically impossible and the experience feel incoherent on mobile.

Why now

- **A funded rebuild.** Solara has committed budget and an expanded internal engineering team (now on React Native). Fantasy's design system will be the foundation they build from.
- **A program relaunch.** Solara Rewards is overhauling its loyalty program — new tiers, expanded earning model, recalibrated financial structure across 48 properties.
- **Executive mandate.** The COO and President has called for an app that feels premium and simple. The client's stated quality bar is "preeminent design."

The rebuild moves from native to React Native. Fantasy is designing the system; the Solara internal team tokenizes and builds from it.

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3. OUTCOMES

1. Figma style guide The visual foundation everything else is generated from. Typography, color, spacing, and component language established early so screen generation can begin immediately.

2. Navigation framework A defined information architecture showing where features live and how users move between sections of the app. The structural skeleton before screens are designed.

3. Core flow screens High-fidelity happy path screens for four co-defined flows, selected with Solara for maximum reusable pattern coverage. Delivered in Figma, engineering-ready, annotated for the React Native team. Confirmed priority order: Booking first → Navigation → [flows 3 and 4 TBD] → Home screen last.

4. Slot-based templates The reusable layout system the Solara internal team inherits and applies to every flow not covered in this engagement. This is what gives the work legs after the engagement closes.

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4. OUT OF SCOPE

Not in scope

- Error states and edge cases — happy path only
- Settings and administrative screens
- Photography production — Fantasy defines image treatment direction; Solara owns the assets
- Component variant production

- Motion design — to be scoped in a future phase

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5. TARGET AUDIENCE

Primary — Regional loyalty members (50+) The volumetric majority. They visit a property regularly, gamble for a couple of hours, and use the app primarily to check and redeem offers. Simplicity and accessibility are non-negotiable.

Secondary

- **Destination travelers** — convention attendees, group trips, first-timers. Plans are fluid. More likely to explore for shows, dining, and on-property discovery.
- **High-value gaming members** — Zenith tier and above. High expectations for personalization and recognition. Use premium features like Contact My Concierge.
- **Non-member / unauthenticated visitors** — arriving from solararewards.com, not yet enrolled. Primary acquisition vector is the member rate incentive during hotel booking.

Key insight The #1 tapped feature in the current app is offers. Any navigation redesign must keep offers immediately accessible. The current home screen fails authenticated members who want personalization, not a billboard.

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6. KEY MESSAGES & STRATEGIC DIRECTION

Loyalty first. Every screen's primary identity is Solara Rewards, not a specific property. Property branding surfaces only when a guest has an active reservation.

Bring it to them. Surface relevant content and actions contextually — don't make members hunt. "The concept of bringing things to them versus making them go chase it."

Celebrate wins, always. The app currently does nothing to acknowledge earning moments, tier upgrades, or dining spend. Celebration and recognition are central to what makes this experience feel different. "It needs to feel gamified — those moments matter."

Premium and approachable. Calm brand confidence, understated luxury. Not flashy. Not sterile. Solara's own framing: "approachable luxury."

Simple enough for everyone. Motion and gamification are desired — but calibrated for an audience that skews older and less tech-forward. Delight without complexity.

Tone of voice: A concierge, not a product manager. Warm, specific, helpful.

Brand constraints

- Primary color: deep gold — non-negotiable
- Primary typeface: existing brand font (Fantasy may propose alternatives; Solara has final say)
- Multiple property brand themes exist — Solara Rewards is the single spine across the product
- The system must support future font and color changes without requiring a redesign

Design references

Marriott Bonvoy is the primary benchmark — for master/sub-brand balance, earned vs. marketing offer separation, leading the account tab with loyalty status, and overall calm visual confidence. Airbnb for utilitarian flows elevated with small motion moments, map-based discovery, and an editorial content model. Nike for subtle AI/conversational search integration and design simplicity with a point of view. Lululemon for how a loyalty program explains itself in-app.

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7. OBJECTIVES & SUCCESS METRICS

The redesign is focused on driving more bookings, deepening offer and rewards engagement, increasing return visits, and growing the enrolled member base. Five KPIs track progress against these goals — targets set for 90 days post-launch against Q4 2025 baselines.

#	What we're moving	Now	Target
1	Booking conversion rate	28%	47%
2	Push notification opt-in rate	30%	70%
3	Offer engagement rate (authenticated sessions with at least one offer tap)	41%	62%
4	30-day return visit rate (members visiting a property within 30 days of an app interaction)	24%	32%
5	New member enrollment via app	14%	35%